EHD
ELITE HOCKEY DRILLS

FREE OFF-ICE PROGRAM · AGES 40+

WEEK ONE



Three joint-friendly 30-minute sessions the Elite Hockey Drills app wrote for a 42-year-old who plays on Thursday nights. No equipment.

3 SESSIONS | 26–33 MIN | NO EQUIPMENT | GAME THU

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WEEK 1 OF THE SEASON

THE WEEK THE APP BUILT.

Not a sample. The real first week of the Elite Hockey Drills program, as the app writes it for this profile:

PLAYER	a 42-year-old, masters player, beginner level
SEASON	In season · game on Thursday
CAN TRAIN	Mon, Tue, Sat · about 30 min
EQUIPMENT	None

Different age, days, equipment or game night? The app rebuilds the week in a minute. This one fits everyone close to this profile.

THE WEEK

MON	**Lower Strength (Joint-Friendly)** STRENGTH — LEGS	30 min
TUE	**Upper Strength (Joint-Friendly)** STRENGTH — UPPER	26 min
WED	**Rest Day**	
THU	**Game Day**	
FRI	**Rest Day**	
SAT	**Hockey Conditioning + Core** AEROBIC CONDITIONING	33 min
SUN	**Rest Day**	

- Hard sessions sit at least 48 hours before the game. The activation day is the day before.
- Tired, sore or sick? Skip the session. Nothing is lost.
- Sneakers, a few metres of floor or grass, a phone for the timer. That is all.

BEFORE DAY 1 · 10 MINUTES

SCORE YOURSELF FIRST.

Three tests, a phone and a tape measure. The same three the app tracks, so week 4 can show what changed. Warm up first (Day 1's warm-up is perfect).

1 BROAD JUMP

Toes behind a line. Swing the arms, jump as far as you can, stick the landing on two feet. Measure from the line to the back of the nearest heel. Best of 3.



2 10 M SPRINT

Mark 10 metres. Start with one hand on the ground. A partner starts the stopwatch on the first movement and stops it when the chest crosses the line. Best of 3, full rest.



3 5-10-5 SHUTTLE

Three markers 4.6 m apart. Start at the middle, hand down. Sprint 5 to the right and touch the line, 10 to the left and touch, 5 back through the middle. Best of 3.

Why these three. Broad jump is the push-off, the sprint is the first three strides, the shuttle is a stop and a change of direction. Every shift uses all three.

THE SCORECARD

WHERE YOU STAND.

Find the row for the age and read across. Anything left of "Average" is where the biggest gains are waiting.

AGE 40+

	AVERAGE	STRONG	ELITE
Broad jump men	≥ 152 cm	≥ 183 cm	≥ 213 cm
Broad jump women	≥ 122 cm	≥ 152 cm	≥ 183 cm
10 m sprint men	≤ 2.35 s	≤ 2.15 s	≤ 2.00 s
10 m sprint women	≤ 2.50 s	≤ 2.30 s	≤ 2.15 s
5-10-5 shuttle men	≤ 5.30 s	≤ 5.00 s	≤ 4.75 s
5-10-5 shuttle women	≤ 5.65 s	≤ 5.30 s	≤ 5.05 s

Week 1: jump _____ cm sprint _____ s shuttle _____ s

Week 4: jump _____ cm sprint _____ s shuttle _____ s

General-population norms the app uses (Topend Sports, FITNESSGRAM, Cartwright, NSCA; the app has a second, harder table for competitive players). In the app, log the three numbers under Testing on the Home screen; the week-4 retest shows the change.

DAY 1 · MONDAY · 30 MIN

LOWER STRENGTH (JOINT-FRIENDLY)

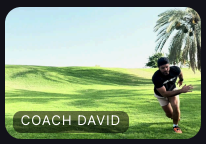
STRENGTH — LEGS | 4 EXERCISES

Slow on the way down, drive up. Leave two or three reps in the tank on every set.

WARM-UP

Light Jog / Dynamic Movement	2 min — easy, conversational pace
Scorpion Stretch ▸	6 reps each side — move through the range
Ankle Dorsiflexion Drill ▸	8 reps each side
World's Greatest Stretch ▸	8 each side — flowing · open hips first

BLOCK A · POWER



A LATERAL BOUND TO STICK

▶ Demo

2 × 4 each side · 60 s rest

LATERAL POWER · crossover + edge-transfer plyometric

1. Start standing on one leg.
2. Push off sideways and land on the OTHER leg — short bound, only 30-40 cm.

On the ice: Youth regression of the standard lateral bound — shorter distance, longer landing pause.

BLOCK B · STRENGTH



B BODYWEIGHT SQUAT

▶ Demo

2 × 10-12 reps · tempo 2-1-X · 75 s rest

STRENGTH · controlled tempo, no max-effort

1. Stand with feet shoulder-width, toes slightly turned out (5-15°).
2. Initiate by pushing the hips BACK — like sitting into a chair behind you.

On the ice: The foundational lower-body pattern — every powerful skating stride starts here.

BLOCK C · STRENGTH



C SPLIT SQUAT

▶ Demo

2 × 10 each leg · tempo 2-1-X · 60 s rest

UNILATERAL · single-leg control

1. Step one foot forward into a long lunge stance. Both feet remain on the floor.
2. Hold dumbbells at sides or bar on the back.

On the ice: Fundamental single-leg strength — great beginner alternative to Bulgarian

BLOCK D · STRENGTH



D GLUTE BRIDGE

▶ Demo

2 × 8 reps · 90 s rest

POSTERIOR CHAIN · hinge pattern is THE highest-leverage masters injury-prevention work. RDL hinge from hips, soft knees, stop at mid-shin.

1. Lie on your back, knees bent at 90°, feet flat on floor hip-width.
2. Arms flat at your sides for stability.

On the ice: Activates and strengthens glutes — the engine of skating

COOL-DOWN

Seated Hamstring Stretch ▸	45-60 sec
Figure-4 Stretch ▸	45-60 sec each side

DAY 2 · TUESDAY · 26 MIN

UPPER STRENGTH (JOINT-FRIENDLY)

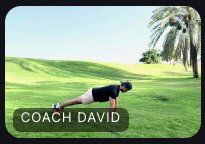
STRENGTH — UPPER | 4 EXERCISES

Slow on the way down, drive up. Leave two or three reps in the tank on every set.

WARM-UP

Light Jog / Dynamic Movement	2 min — easy, conversational pace
Inchworm to Push-Up ▸	6 reps — move through the range
Wall Slide ▸	10 reps
Shoulder Y-T-W ▸	10 reps
Cat-Cow ▸	8 reps — flowing · open the rack

BLOCK A · STRENGTH



A PUSH-UP

▶ Demo

2 × 10-12 reps · tempo 2-1-X · 75 s rest

PUSH · controlled

1. Start in a high plank — hands slightly wider than shoulder-width.
2. Body is perfectly rigid — head to heel in a straight line.

On the ice: Builds pressing strength and core stability simultaneously

BLOCK B · STRENGTH



B INVERTED ROW

▶ Demo

2 × 10-12 reps · tempo 2-1-X · 75 s rest

PULL · bilateral horizontal pull

1. Set up a bar or sturdy table at hip height.
2. Lie underneath, grab the bar with hands shoulder-width or slightly wider, palms facing away.

On the ice: Bodyweight horizontal pull — builds the upper-back strength that protects shoulders...

BLOCK C · PREHAB



C COPENHAGEN ADDUCTION (KNEE-BENT)

▶ Demo

2 × 15-20 sec each leg · 45 s rest

ADDUCTOR · Copenhagen (Hölmich protocol)

1. Lie on your side on the floor, top foot or shin resting on a low couch or bed.
2. Knee BENT (not straight — that's the regression).

On the ice: Builds the inner-thigh strength that protects against groin strain — the most common...

BLOCK D · PREHAB



D NECK ISOMETRIC — FLEXION

▶ Demo

15-20 sec hold · 30 s rest

NECK · concussion prevention

1. Sit or stand tall, spine neutral.
2. Place one or both hands on your forehead.

On the ice: Neck strength is a modifiable concussion risk factor.

COOL-DOWN

Doorway Chest Stretch	8-10 reps each side — slow and controlled
Overhead Tricep Stretch ▸	45-60 sec each side

DAY 3 · SATURDAY · 33 MIN

HOCKEY CONDITIONING + CORE

AEROBIC CONDITIONING | 3 EXERCISES

Conversation pace. This is what makes you recover faster between shifts.

WARM-UP

Light Jog / Dynamic Movement	2 min — easy, conversational pace
Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch ▸	6 reps each side — move through the range
Ankle Hops ▸	12 reps

BLOCK A · CORE



A DEAD BUG

▶ Demo

2 × 8-10 reps · tempo 2-1-X · 45 s rest

MCGILL BIG 3 · anti-extension (bird dog / dead bug)

1. Lie on your back, arms pointing straight up toward the ceiling, knees bent at 90° in the air.
2. Press your lower back FLAT into the floor — eliminate all space between spine and ground.

On the ice: Anti-extension core control — teaches the stability needed at high speeds

BLOCK B · CORE



B SIDE PLANK

▶ Demo

2 × 20-30 sec hold each side · 45 s rest

MCGILL BIG 3 · anti-lateral (side plank)

1. Lie on your side, forearm on the floor, elbow under the shoulder.
2. Stack the feet or stagger them for more stability.

On the ice: Lateral stability — prevents core breakdown during crossovers and tight turns

BLOCK C · AEROBIC

C BRISK WALK (ZONE 2)

15 min — Zone 2 (conversational pace)

ZONE 2 · build mitochondrial density (San Millan)

1. Brisk pace — fast enough that you are breathing through the nose with intent but still able to hold a conversation in full sentences.
2. Target 60-70% max heart rate.

On the ice: The cheapest, most-evidence-backed longevity intervention available.

COOL-DOWN

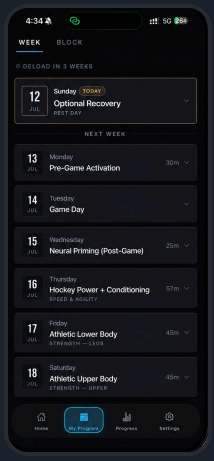
Seated Hamstring Stretch ▸	45-60 sec
Calf Wall Stretch ▸	45-60 sec each side

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

WEEK 2 IS ALREADY WRITTEN.

This PDF is week 1 of 52. The app has the rest, built the same way, for you:

- **Weeks 2–4: the same plan.** When the last set feels easy, the app moves the exercise up a level. Week 4: the three tests again.
- **Week 5: a new block.** New exercises, for example Neck Isometric — Extension.
- Sessions move around your games: hard days 48 hours out, activation the day before.
- A demo video and a coach's note for every exercise. Sets, rest and the timer on the phone.
- The three tests tracked, with the norms you just read.



THE ELITE HOCKEY DRILLS APP

Tell it your age, level, position, days and equipment. It writes the season.

Start the free week →

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Prefer a one-time program? The 8-week programs on elitehockeydrills.com are $79 once, with a 30-day money-back guarantee.

Questions? Reply to the email this program came with. I read every one. — Coach David

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ELITE HOCKEY DRILLS

WEEK 1 IS DONE.
51 TO GO.

The rest of the season is in the app.
Instagram @elite_hockey_drills · elitehockeydrills.com

Start the free week →

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